



Hong Kong Linguistics Olympiad
香港語言學奧林匹克

en

Seventh Hong Kong Linguistics Olympiad

February 23rd, 2025

Problems

- Listen carefully to the invigilators and follow their instructions.
- The contest lasts four hours. The problem set consists of five pages and it contains four problems. You may solve the problems in any order.
- You are not allowed to use any electronic device, written or printed material, or other external sources of information during the contest.
- If you have a question about any of the problems, write it on a piece of draft paper and hand it to an invigilator. The invigilator will consult with the jury and you will receive an answer back written on the same piece of paper.
- Rules for writing out solutions:
 - Do not copy the statements of the problems.
 - Write down your solution to each problem on a separate sheet or sheets.
 - Use only the front side of the answer sheet.
 - On each sheet, indicate your name, the number of the problem, and the page sequence of that sheet within the problem, e.g.:

Name:	...
Problem #	4
Page #	1 / 3

Name:	...
Problem #	4
Page #	2 / 3

Name:	...
Problem #	4
Page #	3 / 3

(meaning first, second, and third sheet out of three for the fourth problem.)

Otherwise, your work may be mislaid or misattributed.

- Unless stated differently, you should describe any patterns or rules you identified in the data. Otherwise, your solution will not be awarded full marks.

The problem set must be kept confidential until it is published on the official HKLO website. Do not disclose nor discuss the problems online until that date.

Problem 1 (25 points). Here are some sentences in Kuchean and their English translations:

1. **arañc ritāwa kuṣaimem ṣpā tukāmai**
I sought the heart and hid from the village.
2. **ṣamāne plāc tukāskām sruketār ṣpā**
The monk conceals the word and dies.
3. **eñkwem pälskāmo**
We remembered the men.
4. **kattāke kuṣaim-ñ kätkā**
The house owner crossed my villages.
5. **śamaški-me srukānte**
Our boys died.
6. **pyāpyaim-ne kolmaine ritanau trikemar ṣpā**
I seek his flowers on the boat and go astray.
7. **kektseñām kaumaine klāyāskem**
We drop the bodies on the pond.
8. **kattāki śamaškem trāppāskem**
The house owners trip the boy.
9. **eñkwi plantānte ṣamānem ṣpā klāyare**
The men rejoiced and dropped the monk.
10. **arañce-ne pälskanām-ñ**
His heart remembers me.
11. **eñkwe trikāskām-me plontotār ṣpā**
The man misleads us and rejoices.
12. **plācāmmem trikāmte kattākem ṣpā oskaine sraukamo**
We went astray from the words and killed the house owners in the house.

(a) Translate into English:

13. **plāci-ñ arañcām traikare**
14. **pyāpyo plānta-ne**
15. **kaumai kuṣaine-ne kätkanau**
16. **kektseñ-me ritanem kolmaiṣmem ṣpā troppomtār**
17. **kolmaiñ oskaiṣne tukentār**

(b) Translate into Kuchean:

18. *I concealed my body.*
19. *The men sought the boy and crossed the house.*
20. *The flowers fall from our boat and die in the ponds.*
21. *The monk gladdens the house owner.*
22. *The hearts remember him and rejoice.*

△ Kuchean, or Tocharian B, belongs to the Indo-European language family. It was spoken in the Tarim Basin of modern-day China, with manuscripts dating from 5th-9th c. AD.

ā and ä are vowels. m, ñ, ś, and ṣ are consonants.

—Tam Lok Hang

Problem 2 (25 points). Here are some verb forms in Nuxalk and their English translations:

mulmap	<i>you_{pl} dive</i>	?ipwtit	<i>they hide them</i>
cpanu	<i>you_{sg} wipe</i>	cptiap	<i>they wipe you_{pl}</i>
?ayaɬc	<i>I walk</i>	?aɬnapic	<i>I know him</i>
kxac	<i>I see</i>	slqtuɬx	<i>you_{sg} find us</i>
?aɬnapcx	<i>you_{sg} know me</i>	kxis	<i>he sees him</i>
?ipwtuɬnu	<i>we hide you_{sg}</i>	mustix	<i>you_{sg} feel them</i>
musiɬ	<i>we feel him</i>	slqct	<i>they find me</i>

(a) Match the following Nuxalk verb forms to their English translations:

- | | |
|-----------------------|--|
| 1. ?awlatup | A. <i>we make him come</i> |
| 2. musatums | B. <i>you_{pl} make us walk</i> |
| 3. ckttuɬ | C. <i>you_{pl} make him follow</i> |
| 4. ?ayaɬtumuɬp | D. <i>we make you_{sg} go</i> |
| 5. λaptumuɬnu | E. <i>he makes me feel</i> |

(b) The verb form **?awlsap** contains an error. Briefly explain why and translate the corrected verb form into English.

(c) Translate into English:

- | | | | |
|-------------------|-----------------------|----------------|-----------------|
| 6. λaptumx | 7. slqatumuɬap | 8. cpip | 9. kxtis |
|-------------------|-----------------------|----------------|-----------------|

(d) Translate into Nuxalk:

- | | | |
|---|--------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| 10. <i>you_{pl} hide</i> | 12. <i>I follow them</i> | 14. <i>they feel him</i> |
| 11. <i>I make you_{sg} hide</i> | 13. <i>you_{sg} know him</i> | 15. <i>they make me dive</i> |

△ Nuxalk is an endangered language of the Salish family spoken in the Bella Coola region of Canada.

? , ɬ , and λ are consonants.

—Faraz Ahmed

Problem 3 (25 points). Below are some equalities written in Meyah:

- a. $\text{egéns} \times \text{setka kuṅkob cinjá erfens} + \text{setka egeka noba tohkuru} = \text{setka tohkuru}$ = 40
- b. $\text{cinjá} \times \text{cinjá orfomu} = \text{setka tohkuru}$ = 40
- c. $\text{egeka} + \text{setka kuṅkob jah enama erfens} = \text{setka kuṅkob jah enama orfomu}$ = 13
- d. $\text{setka kuṅkob jah enama erfens} + \text{cinjá tohkuru} = \text{setka egeka}$ = 20
- e. $\text{tohkuru} + \text{setka egeka noba erfeka} = \text{setka egeka noba cinjá erfens}$
- f. $\text{setka} + \text{cinjá erfeka} = \text{setka kuṅkob cinjá erfeka}$

(a) Write the above equalities in numerals.

(b) Write in digits:

- g. **orgomu**
- h. **setka cinjá erfeka**
- i. **setka egeka noba cinjá**
- j. **setka kuṅkob jah enama tohkuru**

(c) Write in Meyah: 6, 12, 19, 28, 90.

△ Meyah is an East Bird's Head language spoken by 16,000-20,000 people in North Manokwari, Indonesia.

◌́ in **á** and **é** denotes rising pitch.

—Farhan Ishraq

The remainder of this page is intentionally left blank.

Problem 4 (25 points). Here are some Classical Tibetan verb forms and all of their possible English translations:

sos	<i>feed!</i>	dkrol	<i>will play</i>
byon	<i>travelled, will travel, travel!</i>	phud	<i>pulled off, pull off!</i>
bza	<i>will eat</i>	khol	<i>use as a servant!, spin!</i>
dbrad	<i>will scratch</i>	gtad	<i>will lean on</i>
mñan	<i>listened, will listen</i>	bkru	<i>will bathe</i>
phral	<i>separated</i>	bsad	<i>killed</i>
bkal	<i>spun, will spin</i>		

(a) Translate into English:

- | | | | |
|-----------------|----------------|---------------|-----------------|
| 1. bkrol | 3. zos | 5. gso | 7. phrol |
| 2. btad | 4. dpud | 6. ñon | |

All forms only have one possible translation.

(b) Translate into Classical Tibetan:

- | | | | |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|
| 8. <i>used as a servant</i> | 10. <i>will separate</i> | 12. <i>bathe!</i> | 14. <i>scratch!</i> |
| 9. <i>bathed</i> | 11. <i>will kill</i> | 13. <i>lean on!</i> | |

△ Classical Tibetan, also known as Written Tibetan, is a Sino-Tibetan language of the Bodic branch. Since the 12th century, it has been the main literary language of Tibet and associated regions. Traditionally, Tibetan is written in the Tibetan script, but in this problem it has been transliterated into Latin script.

ñ ≈ *ny* in *canyon*; an **h** after a consonant indicates aspiration.

—Wong Tok Shing Henry

Editors: Farhan Ishraq (editor-in-chief), Vlad A. Neacșu (technical editor), Tung-Le Pan, Tam Lok Hang, Wong Tok Shing Henry

Good luck!



Hong Kong Linguistics Olympiad

香港語言學奧林匹克

zh-tr

第七屆香港語言學奧林匹克選拔賽

2025年2月23日

題目

- 仔細聆聽並遵循監考人員的指示。
- 競賽持續四小時。本份試題共有五頁、四題。你可以以任何順序解題。
- 在競賽進行中，請勿使用任何電子設備、手寫筆記、印刷品或是其他的資料來源。
- 如果你對於題目有任何疑問，請將疑問寫在草稿紙上，舉手並將其交給監考人員。監考人員詢問評審委員後會把答覆寫在同一張紙並交回給你。
- 作答規則：
 - 毋須抄題。
 - 將不同問題的解答分述於不同的答題紙上。
 - 請只使用答題紙的正面。
 - 請在每張紙上註明姓名、題號以及其為該題目的第幾張答題紙，例如：

姓名：	...	姓名：	...	姓名：	...
題號：	4	題號：	4	題號：	4
頁碼：	1 / 3	頁碼：	2 / 3	頁碼：	3 / 3

(表示第四題的第一、第二及第三張答題紙。)

以避免考卷遺失或分數誤記。

- 除非特別註明，各題解答應同時包含你在資料中所找到的任何規律或規則。否則你的答案將不會獲得滿分。

在 **HKLO** 官方網站上被公佈前，題目卷必須保密。到該日為止，請勿透過網路公開或討論本次競賽題目。

第一題 (20 分) 以下是一些龜茲語句子及其中文翻譯：

1. **arañc ritāwa kuṣaimem ṣpā tukāmai**
我尋求了心並從村莊躲藏了。
2. **ṣamāne plāc tukāskām sruketār ṣpā**
和尚藏匿話語並死去。
3. **eñkweṃ pālskāmo**
我們記得了男人（複數）。
4. **kattāke kuṣaim-ñ kātka**
屋主通過了我的村莊（複數）。
5. **śamaški-me srukānte**
我們的男孩（複數）死去了。
6. **pyāpyaim-ne kolmaine ritanau trikemar ṣpā**
我在船上尋求他的花（複數）並迷路。
7. **kektseñām kaumaine klāyāskem**
我們在池塘裏放下軀體（複數）。
8. **kattāki śamaškem trāppāskem**
屋主（複數）絆倒男孩。
9. **eñkwi plantānte ṣamānem ṣpā klāyare**
男人（複數）歡喜了並放下了和尚。
10. **arañce-ne pālskanām-ñ**
他的心記得我。
11. **eñkwe trikāskām-me plontotār ṣpā**
男人誤導我們並歡喜。
12. **plācāmmeṃ trikāmte kattākem ṣpā oskaine sraukamo**
我們從話語（複數）偏離了並在屋子裏殺了屋主。

(a) 請翻譯成中文：

13. **plāci-ñ arañcām traikare**
14. **pyāpyo plānta-ne**
15. **kaumai kuṣaine-ne kātkanau**
16. **kektseñ-me ritanem kolmaiṃmeṃ ṣpā troppomtār**
17. **kolmaiñ oskaiṃne tukentār**

(b) 請翻譯成龜茲語：

18. 我藏匿了我的軀體。
19. 男人（複數）尋求了男孩並通過了屋子。
20. 花（複數）從我們的船落下並在池塘（複數）裏死去。
21. 和尚取悅屋主。
22. 心（複數）記得他並歡喜。

△ 龜茲語，或乙種吐火羅語，屬於印歐語系吐火羅語族。該語言曾在現今中國塔里木盆地被使用，其手稿可追溯至公元五至九世紀。

ā 和 ä 是母音。ṃ、ñ、ś、ṣ 是子音。

第二題 (20 分) 以下是一些努哈爾克語動詞形式及其中文翻譯：

mulmap	你們跳水	?ipwtit	他們隱藏他們
cpanu	你擦拭	cptiap	他們擦拭你們
?ayaɬc	我行走	?aɬnapic	我認識他
kxac	我看見	slqtuɬx	你尋找我們
?aɬnapcx	你認識我	kxis	他看見他
?ipwtuɬnu	我們隱藏你	mustix	你感受他們
musiɬ	我們感受他	slqct	他們尋找我

(a) 將以下努哈爾克語動詞形式與其翻譯一一對應：

- | | |
|-----------------------|------------|
| 1. ?awlatup | A. 我們使他來 |
| 2. musatums | B. 你們使我們行走 |
| 3. ckttuɬ | C. 你們使他跟隨 |
| 4. ?ayaɬtumuɬp | D. 我們使你去 |
| 5. ɬaptumuɬnu | E. 他使我感受 |

(b) 動詞形式「**?awlsap**」有誤。簡單解釋錯誤原因，並將更正後的動詞形式翻譯成中文。

(c) 請翻譯成中文：

- | | | | |
|-------------------|-----------------------|----------------|-----------------|
| 6. ɬaptumx | 7. slqatumuɬap | 8. cpip | 9. kxtis |
|-------------------|-----------------------|----------------|-----------------|

(d) 請翻譯成努哈爾克語：

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------|------------|
| 10. 你們隱藏 | 12. 我跟隨他們 | 14. 他們感受他 |
| 11. 我使你隱藏 | 13. 你認識他 | 15. 他們使我跳水 |

△ 努哈爾克語是一種屬於薩利希語系的瀕危語言，在加拿大的貝拉庫拉區使用。
?、ɬ、ɬ 是子音。

—Faraz Ahmed

第三題 (20 分) 以下是一些使用梅亞赫語寫的方程：

- a. $\text{egéns} \times \text{setka kuṅkob cinjá erfens} + \text{setka egeka noba tohkuru} = \text{setka tohkuru} = 40$
- b. $\text{cinjá} \times \text{cinjá orfomu} = \text{setka tohkuru} = 40$
- c. $\text{egeka} + \text{setka kuṅkob jah enama erfens} = \text{setka kuṅkob jah enama orfomu} = 13$
- d. $\text{setka kuṅkob jah enama erfens} + \text{cinjá tohkuru} = \text{setka egeka} = 20$
- e. $\text{tohkuru} + \text{setka egeka noba erfeka} = \text{setka egeka noba cinjá erfens}$
- f. $\text{setka} + \text{cinjá erfeka} = \text{setka kuṅkob cinjá erfeka}$

(a) 以數字書寫以上方程。

(b) 以數字書寫：

- g. **orgomu**
- h. **setka cinjá erfeka**
- i. **setka egeka noba cinjá**
- j. **setka kuṅkob jah enama tohkuru**

(c) 用梅亞赫語寫：6、12、19、28、90。

△ 梅亞赫語屬於東鳥頭語族。在印尼北曼諾瓦里有 16,000 至 20,000 人使用該語言。
á 和 é 中的 ˊ 表示音高上升。

—穆法罕

此處留白。

第四題 (20 分) 以下是一些古典藏語動詞形式其所有可能的中文翻譯：

sos	餵食！	dkrol	會彈
byon	旅行了、會旅行、旅行！	phud	拉下了、拉下！
bza	會吃	khol	用作傭人！、轉！
dbrad	會抓	gtad	會依靠
mñan	聽了、會聽	bkru	會沐浴
phral	分開了	bsad	殺了
bkal	旋轉了、會旋轉		

(a) 請翻譯成中文：

- | | | | |
|-----------------|----------------|---------------|-----------------|
| 1. bkrol | 3. zos | 5. gso | 7. phrol |
| 2. btad | 4. dpud | 6. ñon | |

所有形式都只有一種中文翻譯。

(b) 請翻譯成古典藏語：

- | | | | |
|----------|---------|---------|--------|
| 8. 用作傭人了 | 10. 會分開 | 12. 沐浴！ | 14. 抓！ |
| 9. 沐浴了 | 11. 會殺 | 13. 依靠！ | |

△ 古典藏語，亦稱書面藏語，屬於漢藏語系的藏語支，自十二世紀以來一直是藏語區主要的書面語。藏語傳統上以藏文書寫，但在本題中以拉丁字母轉寫。

ñ 讀若「canyon」的 ny，**h** 代表前面的聲母送氣。

—黃拓承